

Llosa

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The Llosa shawl is a simple triangular shawl. You start at one tip, increase gradually until the middle of the shawl and, from there, work the decreases to the opposite tip. In this shawl we play with colour to create squares: knit with two strands held together, changing the colour of one strand every set number of stitches or rows. This produces squares in different shades and a shawl that's very easy and enjoyable to knit.

In Asturias, a “llosa” is a group of farmland plots in which each neighbour has their own patch.

If you have Instagram, please use the hashtag #llosashawl when you publish photos of your project, or tag me: @tejereningles. If you have any questions about the pattern, please send me an email: tejereningles@gmail.com.

MATERIALS

- 6 mm (US 10) straight or circular needles.
- 9 removable stitch markers, plus 2 additional stitch markers.

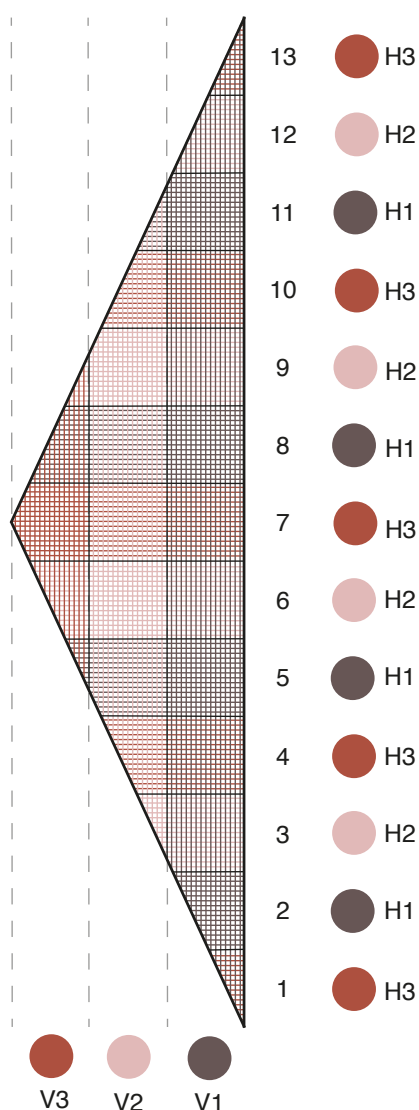
GAUGE

14 st and 28 rows = 10 cm / 4 inches in garter stitch, before blocking. We'll stretch it slightly during blocking.

Tension isn't critical for this shawl, but it may affect the amount of yarn you need and the finished measurements.

MEASUREMENTS

After blocking: approx. 200 cm / 79 inches long and 45 cm / 18 inches wide at the widest point.



YARN

We'll use two strands held together throughout the shawl. One strand comes from the ball we'll use for each "vertical" column (i.e. it's used in each column of squares throughout the length of the shawl), and the other strand comes from the ball we'll use for the "horizontal" bands (i.e. it's used for each new colour band across the width of each row).

I'll refer to the balls of yarn you need as follows:

- | | |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| V1: vertical ball, colour 1 | H1: horizontal ball, colour 1 |
| V2: vertical ball, colour 2 | H2: horizontal ball, colour 2 |
| V3: vertical ball, colour 3 | H3: horizontal ball, colour 3 |

I used six balls in total (but not fully –see quantities below): 3 colours × 2 balls per colour, one for the vertical columns and the other for the horizontal bands. I'd recommend using three different colours for the vertical columns, and you can either use the same three for the horizontal bands or use scrap yarn to make each band a different colour.

YARN WEIGHT

Two strands of lace-weight yarn held together. I used De Rerum Natura Bérénice (55% mohair, 25% silk, 20% merino). As we're knitting with 6 mm (US 10) needles, you can combine various weights –lace + fingering, two strands of fingering, fingering + sport, lace + sport, two strands of sport, etc. –but the colours blend more subtly when you use a yarn with a halo, such as mohair, alpaca, etc.

COLOURS AND YARDAGE

V1: 210 m / 230 yd. I used the colour Cacao (brown).

V2: 136 m / 149 yd. I used the colour Argile (pink).

V3: 48 m / 52 yd. I used the colour Erable (orange).

H1: 135 m / 148 yd. I used the colour Cacao (brown).

H2: 135 m / 148 yd. I used the colour Argile (pink).

H3: 140 m / 153 yd. I used the colour Erable (orange).

If you'd like to use scrap yarn in different colours for each horizontal band, here are the approximate amounts:

- | | |
|----------------------|-----------------------|
| Band 1: 9 m / 10 yd | Band 8: 50 m / 55 yd |
| Band 2: 17 m / 19 yd | Band 9: 42 m / 46 yd |
| Band 3: 25 m / 27 yd | Band 10: 33 m / 36 yd |
| Band 4: 33 m / 36 yd | Band 11: 25 m / 27 yd |
| Band 5: 42 m / 46 yd | Band 12: 17 m / 19 yd |
| Band 6: 50 m / 55 yd | Band 13: 9 m / 10 yd |
| Band 7: 57 m / 62 yd | |

Colour your own shawl on the next page.

ABBREVIATIONS

k2tog: knit 2 together (1 stitch decreased)

K: knit

kfb: knit front and back. Knit the stitch through the front loop and then, without dropping it from the needle, knit it again through the back loop. You have increased 1 st. See video in *Tutorials*.

H1, H2, H3: balls of yarn for the horizontal bands, colours 1, 2, 3.

m: marker

RS: right side

sl1wyif: slip 1 with yarn in front. Bring the yarn to the front of the work and slip 1 stitch purlwise. If the next stitch is a knit, take the yarn to the back of the work before you continue with the next stitch. If the next stitch is a purl, leave the yarn at the front. See video in *Tutorials*.

sm: slip marker

st: stitch(es)

V1, V2, V3: ball of yarn for the vertical columns, colours 1, 2, 3.

WS: wrong side

TUTORIALS

Stitches

sl1wyif (selvedge): <https://youtu.be/8wdUj0VOxoY>

kfb: <https://youtu.be/yYR51Z6o1hM>

Techniques

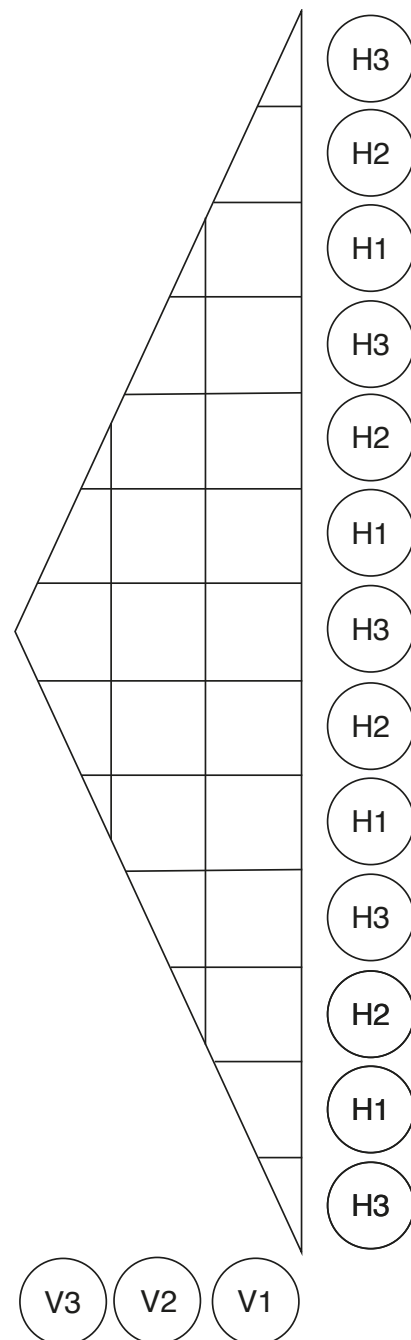
Long tail cast on: <https://youtu.be/JC7ZiW6aoH8>

Weaving in ends as you go:

English style: <https://youtu.be/PdKsONos1cs>

Continental style: <https://youtu.be/CWFFNsU9FsU>

COLOUR YOUR OWN SHAWL



DIRECTIONS

This is a triangular shawl that starts at one tip; you work increases until the middle (the widest part) and then work decreases to the opposite tip. The shape and construction are very straightforward. Squares in different colours are formed by combining two different strands: one for the horizontal bands and one for the vertical columns. Because you keep the same horizontal strand across the full row, you don't need any special colourwork technique such as intarsia when changing the colour of the vertical column – simply drop the vertical strand and join the next.

Vertical (columns): colour changes every 21 st.

Horizontal (bands): colour changes every 36 rows.

Before you begin, to avoid mixing up the balls of yarn for the vertical columns and the horizontal bands –especially when cutting the horizontal strand – I recommend putting all the horizontal balls in a bag and keeping them there. These are the balls you cut at the end of each band of 36 rows. Keep the vertical balls of yarn out in front of you, as you'll be moving them all the time. These are never cut.

1. CAST ON

Hold together one strand of V1 (vertical ball, colour 1) and one strand of H3 (horizontal ball, colour 3) and cast on 4 st using the long tail cast on (see *Tutorials*).

2. BAND 1

Balls of yarn: V1 + H3

Row 1 (RS): Sl1wyif, K to 2 st before the end, kfb, K1. 1 st increased. Place a removable (locking) stitch marker on the increase to make it easier to see when it's time to work the next increase and to track how many you've worked in total (we'll be doing 9 per band).

Row 2 (WS): Sl1wyif, K to the end.

Row 3 (RS): Sl1wyif, K to the end.

Row 4 (WS): Sl1wyif, K to the end.

Repeat **rows 1–4** 8 more times. You have 13 st on the needles and you'll have completed 36 rows. Cut H3 (the ball in the bag).



3. BAND 2

Balls of yarn: V1 and V2 + H1

Continue with the V1 strand and join H1 so you're knitting with both strands held together. I recommend weaving in your ends as you go (see *Tutorials*). If you're using the colours in the same order as I did, you'll have two strands of the same colour for the first square. The H1 ball you're joining now is the one you'll cut after 36 rows –keep this ball in the bag at all times to remind you it's the one to cut at the end of this band.

Repeat **rows 1–4** 8 more times. Remove the increase markers from the previous band as you need them and place them in this band. That way you'll only ever need 9 markers, and it helps you see when you've completed all the increases for the band. You now have 21 st and have worked a further 32 rows.

Row 33 (RS): Sl1wyif, K to 2 st before the end, kfb. One stitch remains on the needle. Drop (do not cut) the V1 strand (the ball you've used from the start) and let it hang at the front of the work (towards you); place a marker on the right-hand needle. Now take the V2 ball and, holding it together with the H1 strand (the ball you joined a few rows ago), knit the final stitch. In other words, you're working the first 21-stitch square with V1 + H1 and, from now on, the remaining stitches with V2 + H1.

Row 34 (WS): Sl1wyif, sm, drop the V2 strand to the front of the work (towards you) and rejoin the V1 strand you left on the RS. With V1 + H1, K to the end.

Row 35 (RS): With V1 + H1, sl1wyif, K to the m, sm, K the remaining st with V2 + H1. Remember to leave the strand you're not using at the front of the work (towards you) so you can use it on the next row.

Row 36 (WS): Sl1wyif, sm, drop the V2 strand (do not cut) and rejoin V1. K to the end. You have completed the 36 rows for this band. Cut H1. You have 22 st (21 st with V1 and 1 st with V2) and a further 36 rows worked (72 rows in total).

4. BAND 3

Balls of yarn: V1 and V2 + H2

Continue with the V1 strand for the first 21 st and V2 for the remaining st, and join H2.

Repeat **rows 1-4** remembering to switch from V1 to V2 after the first 21 st (where we placed the marker). On the first row of this section you'll work the kfb increase exactly on stitch 21: knit the front loop with V1, then switch to V2 to knit the back loop of the same stitch to complete the increase.

Row 1 (RS): With V1 + H2, sl1wyif, K to 1 st before the m, kfb (for the increase, knit the front loop with V1 and the back loop with V2), remove the marker, K1 with V2 + H2.

Row 2 (WS): With V2 + H2, sl1wyif, K1, pm. Bring the V2 strand to the front (towards you) and rejoin the V1 strand you left at the back of the work. With V1 + H2, K to the end.

Row 3 (RS): With V1 + H2, sl1wyif, K to the m, sm. With V2 + H2, K to the end.

Row 4 (WS): With V2 + H2, sl1wyif, K to the m, sm. With V1 + H2, K to the end.

NOTE: To keep the balls of yarn organised, here's what worked for me: as I mentioned before, I keep the horizontal balls in a bag and only touch them when it's time to cut the yarn at the end of a band. I put the vertical balls on the table in front of me and, when I finish with a vertical ball and need to change to the next, I wind that ball up, bring it to the front of the work between the two needles (towards me), and leave it on my lap. When I turn the work to start the next row, I move the balls from my lap back onto the table and start again. This way I always know which ball is which and avoid tangling them when turning the work.

If the join between columns looks loose, make sure you give the horizontal strand a good tug as you knit the first st of the new column. It's the horizontal strand that holds everything together, so it's important it isn't too slack. It's possible that the marker you've placed between the columns is stopping you from pulling the yarn tightly enough. If that's the case, remove the markers and just remember to change vertical ball every 21 st (it should be easy to see). Finally, if you still feel there's too much of a gap between the columns, you can cross the new vertical ball over the old one before bringing the old one to the front of the work. This twists the strands together and makes it more secure (in other words, here you'd be using the intarsia technique). I decided not to do this because I don't mind a small gap in such an airy shawl.

Continue working an increase row every 4 rows and changing the vertical colour every 21 st until you have completed this band, i.e. 36 rows and 9 increases. It's easy to see when you finish each band because you'll

have used the 9 removable markers from the previous band. Remember to work 3 rows without increases after the last increase to make up the 36 rows.

At the end of this band you'll have 31 st (21 st with V1 and 10 st with V2) and a further 36 rows worked (108 rows in total). Cut H2.

5. BAND 4

Balls of yarn: V1 and V2 + H3

Continue with the V1 strand for the first 21 st and V2 for the remaining st, and join H3.

Repeat the following **rows 1-4** 9 times in total, remembering to switch from V1 to V2 at the marker.

Row 1 (RS): With V1 + H3, sl1wyif, K to the m, sm. With V2 + H3, K to 2 st before the end, kfb, K1. Remember to place a removable st marker on the increase.

Row 2 (WS): With V2 + H3, sl1wyif, K to the m, sm. With V1 + H3, K to the end.

Row 3 (RS): With V1 + H3, sl1wyif, K to the m, sm. With V2 + H3, K to the end.

Row 4 (WS): With V2 + H3, sl1wyif, K to the m, sm. With V1 + H3, K to the end.

At the end of this band you'll have 40 st (21 st with V1 and 19 st with V2) and a further 36 rows worked (144 rows in total). Cut H3.

6. BAND 5

Balls of yarn: V1, V2 and V3 + H1

Begin with V1 and join H1. In this band you'll use V1 for the first 21 st, V2 for the next 21 st, and you'll begin the third column with V3.

Row 1 (RS): With V1 + H1, sl1wyif, K to the m, sm. With V2 + H1, K to 2 st before the end, kfb, K1. Place a removable st marker on the increase.

Row 2 (WS): With V2 + H1, sl1wyif, K to the m, sm. With V1 + H1, K to the end.

Row 3 (RS): With V1 + H1, sl1wyif, K to the m, sm. With V2 + H1, K to the end.

Row 4 (WS): With V2 + H1, desl1hf, K to the m, sm. With V1 + H1, K to the end.

Repeat **rows 1-4** once more (8 rows in total).

Row 9 (RS): With V1 + H1, sl1wyif, K to the m, sm. With V2 + H1, K to 2 st before the end, kfb, pm, drop

V2 and join V3. With V3 + H1, K1. Place a removable st marker on the increase.

Row 10 (WS): With V3 + H1, sl1wyif, sm. With V2 + H1, K to the next m, sm. With V1 + H1, K to the end.

Row 11 (RS): With V1 + H1, sl1wyif, K to the m, sm. With V2 + H1, K to the next m. With V3 + H1, K1.

Row 12 (WS): With V3 + H1, sl1wyif, sm. With V2 + H1, K to the next m, sm. With V1 + H1, K to the end.

On the next row you'll work the kfb increase knitting the front loop with V2 and the back loop with V3 (as in Row 1 of Band 3). Move the marker between these two st on the following WS row. Make sure you have 21 st in each of the V1 and V2 columns.

Continue working one increase row every 4 rows, and switch the vertical colour every 21 st, until you've completed the band: 36 rows and 9 increases.

At the end of this band you'll have 49 st (21 st with V1, 21 with V2, and 7 with V3) and a further 36 rows worked (180 rows in total). Cut H1.

7. BAND 6

Balls of yarn: V1, V2 and V3 + H2

Begin with V1 and join H2. In this band you'll use V1 for the first 21 st, V2 for the next 21 st and V3 for the remaining st.



Row 1 (RS): With V1 + H2, sl1wyif, K to the m, sm. With V2 + H2, K to the next m, sm. With V3 + H2, K to 2 st before the end, kfb, K1. Place a removable m on the increase.

Row 2 (WS): With V3 + H2, sl1wyif, K to the m, sm. With V2 + H2, K to the m, sm. With V1 + H2, K to the end.

Row 3 (RS): With V1 + H2, sl1wyif, K to the m, sm. With V2 + H2, K to the next m. With V3 + H2, K to the end.

Row 4 (WS): With V3 + H2, sl1wyif, K to the m, sm. With V2 + H2, K to the m, sm. With V1 + H2, K to the end.

Repeat **rows 1-4** 8 more times, remembering to switch from V1 to V2 when you get to the first m and from V2 to V3 when you get to the second m.

At the end of this band you'll have 58 st (21 st with V1, 21 st with V2, and 16 st with V3) and a further 36 rows worked (216 rows in total). Cut H2.

8. BAND 7

Balls of yarn: V1, V2 and V3 + H3

Begin with V1 and join H3. In this band you'll use V1 for the first 21 st, V2 for the next 21 st and V3 for the remaining st.

Row 1 (RS): With V1 + H3, sl1wyif, K to the m, sm. With V2 + H3, K to the next m, sm. With V3 + H3, K to 2 st before the end, kfb, K1. Place a removable m on the increase.

Row 2 (WS): With V3 + H3, sl1wyif, K to the m, sm. With V2 + H3, K to the m, sm. With V1 + H3, K to the end.

Row 3 (RS): With V1 + H3, sl1wyif, K to the m, sm. With V2 + H3, K to the next m. With V3 + H3, K to the end.

Row 4 (WS): With V3 + H3, sl1wyif, K to the m, sm. With V2 + H3, K to the m, sm. With V1 + H3, K to the end.

Repeat **rows 1-4** 4 more times (5 increases in total). You have 20 rows in this band. We've reached the halfway point of the shawl. You should have 63 st in total, 21 st in each colour. From now on we'll work decreases to return to a point at the end. To keep the instructions simpler, from here on I won't include notes about when to change the vertical colour – remember to do so every 21 st.

Row 21 (RS): Sl1wyif, K to 3 st before the end, k2tog, K1. 1 st decreased. Place a removable marker on the decrease.

Row 22 (WS): Sl1wyif, K to the end.

Row 23 (RS): Sl1wyif, K to the end.

Row 24 (WS): Sl1wyif, K to the end.

Repeat **rows 21-24** 3 more times. At the end of this band you'll have 59 st (21 st with V1, 21 st with V2 and 17 st with V3) and a further 36 rows worked (252 rows in total). Cut H3.

9. BANDS 8-13

Continue working one decrease every 4 rows and change the horizontal colour every 36 rows (9 decreases) until, at the end of Band 13, you have 5 st remaining.

The colours and the number of st and rows in each band are:

Band 8: V1, V2 and V3 + H1. 50 st in total (21, 21 and 8). 288 rows in total.

Band 9: V1, V2 and V3 + H2. 41 st in total (21 and 20 – you will stop using V3 when you start the eighth decrease of this band). 328 rows in total.

Band 10: V1 and V2 + H3. 32 st in total (21 and 11). 364 rows in total.

Band 11: V1 and V2 + H1. 23 st in total (21 and 2). 400 rows in total.

Band 12: V1 and V2 + H2. 14 st in total – you will stop using V2 when you start the second decrease of this band. 436 rows in total.

Band 13: V1 + H3. 5 st in total. 472 rows in total.

10. BIND OFF AND FINISHING

You have 5 st. With V1 and H3, bind off the first 3 st, then knit the last 2 st together before casting off that final st.

Weave in the ends and block the shawl. Soak it in lukewarm water (on the cool side) for 15–20 minutes. When laying it out to dry I recommend stretching the shawl across the widest part first until it measures approximately 45 cm (17¾ in) and pinning it. Then gently stretch out towards the sides until both halves of the shawl reach the same length, approximately 200 cm (79 inches) in total.

I hope you have enjoyed knitting this pattern. Please do not share or sell this pattern or the garments made by following it.

You can find all my patterns on Ravelry:
www.ravelry.com/designers/belen-fernandez

Or you can scan the QR code with your phone camera.

